

# Wednesday, 5 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

## Tomorrow's forecast

|                               |                                   |                                  |                                  |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| LONDON<br>Overcast<br>24° 18° | BIRMINGHAM<br>Overcast<br>20° 15° | MANCHESTER<br>Drizzle<br>19° 14° | GLASGOW<br>Light rain<br>18° 14° |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|

01 — NEWS

## Today's top stories

- 1

**The Justice Secretary has apologised to families affected by the early release of some offenders, after a scheme designed to ease prison overcrowding.**

Some offenders will now be barred from the scheme, but families of victims say the apology comes at their expense. The government is facing pressure over the justice system.

CRIME · UK
- 2

**More than 150 migrants have been rescued after a boat attempting to cross the Channel caught fire in French waters.**

French authorities confirmed the incident, stating the boat's engine ignited during the crossing. All individuals on board were brought to safety.

MIGRATION · UK
- 3

**A new study warns that current NHS checks are missing up to 95% of younger women at higher risk of breast cancer.**

The research highlights a significant gap in screening for women under 50 who have an elevated risk. Experts are calling for a review of existing protocols.

HEALTH · UK
- 4

**The UK heatwave is set to end with a bang today, as thunderstorms and a risk of flash flooding are forecast for southern and eastern England.**

While some areas will still hit heatwave criteria on Tuesday, cooler temperatures are on the horizon for the rest of the week. Get ready for a change in the weather!

WEATHER · UK
- 5

**A former neo-Nazi activist, who was jailed for antisemitic remarks, has been selected as a Conservative Party candidate.**

Joshua Bonehill-Paine served time in prison following his conviction in 2015. His selection has sparked considerable debate and criticism.

POLITICS · UK

## What's coming up

- 1 Spider-Man fans are hailing Tom Holland's latest web-slinging adventure, 'Brand New Day', as his best performance yet!**

The new film is generating huge buzz, with many viewers praising Holland's portrayal of the iconic superhero. It seems like a must-see for Marvel enthusiasts.

**ON AIR** – Are you a Spider-Man fan? What makes a great superhero movie for you?

FILM · THIS WEEK
- 2 Glasgow is taking centre stage in the new 'Spider-Man: Brand New Day' film, doubling as New York City!**

Scotland's largest city provided the backdrop for many scenes in the latest Marvel blockbuster. It's fantastic to see British locations getting such a prominent role.

**ON AIR** – Have you spotted any familiar Glasgow landmarks in the film? What's your favourite movie location?

FILM · THIS WEEK
- 3 British girl band FLO are confidently aiming for global domination, describing the making of their second album as a 'crash course' in music.**

The rising stars are generating excitement with their new album, 'Therapy at the Club'. They're certainly one to watch in the music scene.

**ON AIR** – Who are your favourite emerging British music acts right now?

MUSIC · COMING SOON
- 4 London is set to host the debut Mahrajan Festival, a 'milestone' event celebrating Arabic culture with an exciting line-up of artists.**

The festival will feature performances from artists like Saint Levant and Dystinct, promising a vibrant celebration of music and culture. It's a fantastic addition to the capital's summer events.

**ON AIR** – Are you planning to check out the Mahrajan Festival? What cultural events are you looking forward to this summer?

FESTIVAL · THIS WEEK
- 5 Fans are flocking to the US edition of Love Island, saying 'they actually fancy each other' and questioning what the UK version could do to draw in more viewers.**

Commentators and former Islanders are weighing in on the differences between the two shows. It seems the US version is hitting all the right notes with viewers.

**ON AIR** – Are you a Love Island fan, and which version do you prefer? What makes a good dating show?

TV · THIS WEEK

## On the schedule

- 1 Arsenal are reportedly in direct talks with Newcastle United to sign their captain, Bruno Guimaraes.**  
 This potential transfer would be a significant move in the Premier League. Keep an eye on this space as the negotiations unfold.  
**ON AIR** – If you're an Arsenal or Newcastle fan, what do you make of this potential transfer? Will he be a good fit?  
 FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 British heavyweight Moses Itauma's fight against Filip Hrgovic on August 29th has been upgraded to a bout for the vacant IBF world title!**  
 This is huge news for Itauma, who now has the chance to fight for a major world championship. It promises to be an unmissable night for boxing fans.  
**ON AIR** – Are you excited for this world title fight? Do you think Itauma has what it takes to win?  
 BOXING · UK
- 3 Celtic have kicked off their Scottish Premiership title defence with a narrow home victory against Dundee, thanks to a header from Benjamin Nygren.**  
 It was a tight match, but Celtic secured the win to start their season on a positive note. A good start for the reigning champions!  
**ON AIR** – For our Scottish football fans, what are your predictions for Celtic this season? Can they defend their title?  
 FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 Welsh Fire claimed their fourth win in five matches in The Hundred, with a well-crafted half-century from Matt Short helping them defeat Southern Brave.**  
 It was a dramatic finish, with Fire chasing down 122 runs with the final ball of the game. A thrilling win for the Welsh side!  
**ON AIR** – Are you enjoying The Hundred this season? Which team are you backing?  
 CRICKET · UK
- 5 With Rangers, Hearts, Hibernian, and Motherwell all in European action this Thursday, what did the Premiership start tell us about their chances?**  
 Scottish clubs are gearing up for big European nights, and their opening league performances offer some clues. It's an exciting week for Scottish football fans.  
**ON AIR** – Which Scottish club do you think has the best chance in Europe this season? What are your predictions?  
 FOOTBALL · UK

## Quick hits

- 1 Scientists are exploring the fascinating world of 'tiny house plants' and their surprising benefits for well-being.**  
Research suggests that even miniature greenery on your desk or windowsill can boost mood and reduce stress, bringing a touch of nature indoors without needing much space.
- 2 A new study reveals the 'joy of handwritten letters' is making a comeback, especially among younger generations.**  
Many are finding a unique charm in the personal touch of a handwritten note, appreciating the effort and thoughtfulness in a world dominated by instant digital messages.
- 3 The simple act of 'observing street art' is gaining recognition as a delightful way to experience local culture.**  
From intricate murals to playful installations, public art provides a free and accessible gallery experience, encouraging people to look up and appreciate their surroundings.
- 4 Experts are highlighting the unexpected appeal of 'collecting unique pebbles' found on beaches and riverbanks.**  
This gentle hobby offers a peaceful way to connect with nature, with each stone telling its own geological story and adding a touch of natural beauty to home decor.
- 5 There's a growing trend towards 'swapping homemade goods' with neighbours and friends.**  
Whether it's a freshly baked loaf, garden produce, or a jar of jam, this delightful exchange fosters community spirit and reduces waste, sharing culinary talents in a lovely way.
- 6 A recent report points to the 'comforting appeal of listening to classic radio dramas' from bygone eras.**  
Many are rediscovering the imaginative power of audio storytelling, offering a relaxing escape from screen time and transporting listeners to different worlds with just their ears.
- 7 The humble 'picnic in a local park' is being celebrated as the perfect low-cost, high-joy activity for families.**  
With just a blanket and some sandwiches, it's an easy way to enjoy the outdoors, spend quality time together, and watch the world go by without any fuss.

05 – TALKBACK

## For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

- Q** Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our shopping trolley, even if we know it's not going to make it go any faster?

**ANSWER:** WOBBLING THE FRONT WHEELS FROM SIDE TO SIDE LIKE IT'S A RACING CAR!

- Q** Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh piece of fruit. What is it?

**ANSWER:** GIVING IT A LITTLE TAP OR GENTLE SQUEEZE, JUST TO MAKE SURE IT'S PERFECT!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday sound' can just instantly make you feel incredibly calm or happy?**  
Perhaps it's the gentle hum of the washing machine, the distant sound of church bells, or the simple click of a kettle boiling. What's that one ordinary sound that brings a smile to your face?
- **We all have those 'little rituals' we do throughout the day that nobody else really notices, but they make our day run a tiny bit smoother.**  
Maybe it's how you organise your keys, the specific order you put on your shoes, or a particular route you take to avoid a puddle. What's your unnoticed daily ritual?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

**FACT** **History.** During World War II, carrots were promoted by the British government as a way to help pilots

see in the dark, but this was actually a clever ruse to disguise the real reason for their improved night vision: newly developed radar technology.

**FICTION** **Made up, but believable.** The first ever recorded 'traffic jam' in history occurred in ancient Rome

when a flock of sheep escaped from a market and blocked one of the city's main thoroughfares for an entire day.

06 – LOTTERY

## Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

**£6.8 million**

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

**£6.8 million**

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

## Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not.
- The inventor of the Pringles can is buried in one.
- The first orange cultivated in Europe was bitter, not sweet, and was primarily used for medicinal purposes.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.
- There are more fake flamingos in the world than real ones.
- The smell of freshly cut grass is actually a plant distress signal.

## On this day

Day 217 of the year, 148 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abel of Reims; Christian feast day: Addai; Christian feast day: Afra; Christian feast day: Cassian of Autun. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

### TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — Ryan Bertrand, English footballer
- 1961 — Tim Wilson, American comedian, singer-songwriter, and guitarist (died 2014)
- 1946 — Erika Slezak, American actress
- 1955 — Eddie Ojeda, American guitarist and songwriter
- 1945 — Loni Anderson, American actress (died 2025)
- 1967 — Matthew Caws, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1966 — Jennifer Finch, American singer, bass player, and photographer (died 2026)
- 1961 — Mark O'Connor, American violinist/fiddler and composer

### THE DAY TODAY

- 1995 — Yugoslav Wars: The city of Knin, Croatia, a significant Serb stronghold, is taken by Croatian forces during Operation Storm. The date is celebrated in Croatia as Victory Day.
- 1974 — Watergate scandal: President Richard Nixon, under orders of the US Supreme Court, releases the "Smoking Gun" tape, recorded on June 23, 1972, clearly revealing his actions in covering up and interfering investigations into the break-in. His political support vanishes completely.
- 1965 — The Indo-Pakistani war of 1965 begins as Pakistani soldiers cross the Line of Control dressed as locals.

### TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1957 — American Bandstand, a show dedicated to the teenage "baby-boomers" by playing the songs and showing popular dances of the time, debuts on the ABC television network.
- 1974 — Watergate scandal: President Richard Nixon, under orders of the US Supreme Court, releases the "Smoking Gun" tape, recorded on June 23, 1972, clearly revealing his actions in covering up and interfering investigations into the break-in. His political support vanishes completely.

### TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1963 — Cold War: The United States, the United Kingdom, and the Soviet Union sign the Partial Nuclear Test Ban Treaty.

- 1949 — In Montana, 12 smokejumper firefighters and 1 US Forest Service fire guard are killed in the Mann Gulch Fire.
- 1971 — The first Pacific Islands Forum (then known as the "South Pacific Forum") is held in Wellington, New Zealand, with the aim of enhancing cooperation between the independent countries of the Pacific Ocean.



## A peek at tomorrow

Day 218 of the year, 147 days left in 2026. Today Christian holidays and observances Transfiguration of Jesus; Christian holidays and observances Anna Maria Rubatto; Christian holidays and observances Pope Hormisdas; Christian holidays and observances Justus and Pastor. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

### TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1959 — Joyce Sims, American singer (died 2022)
- 1942 — Byard Lancaster, American saxophonist and flute player (died 2012)
- 1961 — Mary Ann Sieghart, English journalist and radio host
- 1937 — Charlie Haden, American bassist and composer (died 2014)
- 1954 — Mark Hughes, English-Australian rugby league player
- 1928 — Andy Warhol, American painter, photographer and film director (died 1987)
- 1951 — Catherine Hicks, American actress
- 1938 — Paul Bartel, American actor, director, and screenwriter (died 2000)

### THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1986 — A low-pressure system that redeveloped off the New South Wales coast dumps a record 328 millimeters (13 inches) of rain in a day on Sydney, New South Wales, Australia.
- 2012 — NASA's Curiosity rover lands on the surface of Mars.
- 2015 — A suicide bomb attack kills at least 15 people at a mosque in the Saudi city of Abha.

### TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2011 — War in Afghanistan: A United States military helicopter is shot down, killing 30 American special forces members and a working dog, seven Afghan soldiers, and one Afghan civilian. It was the deadliest single event for the United States in the War in Afghanistan.
- 1956 — After going bankrupt in 1955, the American broadcaster DuMont Television Network makes its final broadcast, a boxing match from St. Nicholas Arena in New York in the Boxing from St. Nicholas Arena series.

## Coming to cinemas

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### AUGUST 2026

|        |                                                 |
|--------|-------------------------------------------------|
| FRI 7  | Once Upon a Time in a Cinema                    |
| FRI 14 | Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie |
| FRI 21 | Mutiny; The Bride!                              |
| FRI 28 | Crime 101; Outcome                              |

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### SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

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|--------|-----------------------|
| FRI 4  | Conjuring: Last Rites |
| FRI 11 | Resident Evil reboot  |
| FRI 18 | The Black Phone 2     |
| FRI 25 | Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)   |

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### OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

|        |                                         |
|--------|-----------------------------------------|
| FRI 16 | Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller |
| FRI 23 | Frankenstein (del Toro)                 |

## On the sporting calendar

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### AUGUST 2026

|        |                                        |
|--------|----------------------------------------|
| W/C 10 | Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)   |
| SAT 15 | Premier League season begins (2026/27) |
| 22–23  | Belgian Grand Prix (F1)                |